

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠3

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦6

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠2

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 4 2

♥ Q 8 2

♦ 7 4

♣ Q J 3

♠ A 10 6

♥ A 7 4

♦ K Q 10 2

♣ K 8 4



♠ Q 9

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ J 9 5

♣ A 10 7 2

♠ 8 5 3

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

West

Pass

All Pass

1NT by North

Lead: ♥3

North

1NT

*East**South*

NORTH has a perfect 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows that the most points the partnership could hold is 24 (7 + 17). Since this is below the 26 point game requirement he passes.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

♠ K J 6 5

♥ 7 5 3

♦ A 6

♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ A Q 4
♥ K 10 8
♦ J 10 9 5
♣ A Q 6

♠ 8 3 2

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ 8 4 2

♣ J 9 5

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening - 16 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST also has a balanced hand she bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 3

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5
♥ Q J 10 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ J 8 4 3

♠ A J 3
♥ A 8 7
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ Q 10 7



♠ 10 9 6 4
♥ 4 2
♦ K 7 6 3
♣ K 9 2

♠ K Q 8 2
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 6 5

SOUTH has 16 points and balanced distribution. She naturally opens 1NT.

NORTH has 14 points and balanced distribution so he does the math. The partnership has at least 29 points (14 + 15). The partnership has at most 31 points (14 + 17).

Since this is more than the 26 needed for game, but fewer than the 33 needed for slam NORTH just bids 3NT, knowing SOUTH will respect his decision and pass.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥Q			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 6
♥ A J 5
♦ A Q J
♣ A 9 3 2

♠ 10 4 3
♥ K 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10
♣ Q J 10

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 5 2
♥ 8 7 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ 7 6 5

♠ Q 8 7
♥ Q 4
♦ 8 7 6 5 2
♣ K 8 4

When WEST opens 1NT, EAST knows that he cannot have more than 17 points. So with her 7 points, she knows there is no reason to respond.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Lead: ♣Q

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 7 5 4

♥ 8 7 6

♦ 10

♣ A 8 4 2

♠ K Q J

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 8

♣ Q J 10

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 2

♥ A 10 3

♦ Q 9 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 10 8 6 3

♥ K 4 2

♦ K 4 3

♣ K 7 5

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♦ 6

North

1NT

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener.

SOUTH has 9 points: - if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game. - if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game. Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she accepts the invitation.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ Q 6 5
♣ K J 9 3

♠ Q 3

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ 8 7 3 2

♣ 7 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 7 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8

♠ K J 5 2

♥ 8 6 3

♦ K 10 9

♣ A 6 4

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 2

With 9 points WEST is unable to decide the final contract. If EAST has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If EAST opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So WEST makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells EAST that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal EAST has 17 points so he bids 3NT.